

India-China: Towards Rapprochement

India and China are making **concerted** efforts to **resolve long-standing** issues that have **plagued** the relations between the two countries but the **momentum** must be maintained

After a long gap and years of tension, there is some **respite** in India-China relations. For the past few years it has been an **uneasy** relationship, even the visa services were **disrupted** between the two countries. However, after a low point in relations after incidents like Galwan **clash** in 2020, things are now **looking up**. Visa services are **restored** and now more confidence-building measures are expected which would at least make relations functional if not **cordial**.

In a **significant breakthrough** signalling a **thaw** in bilateral relations, India and China have taken **decisive** steps to **reset** their diplomatic and **strategic** engagement. A high-level **meeting** between visiting Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi and Prime Minister Narendra Modi and External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar **has broken the ice**. The **discussions**, focused on building trust and reducing tensions, **resulted in** the agreement to work toward an early **settlement** of the longstanding boundary issue. **An Expert Group** under the Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination on India-China Border Affairs (WMCC) **will** now be **set up** to **explore** a **mutually** acceptable **framework** for **delimiting** the border. This will involve defining the boundary legally and politically without necessarily **erecting** physical **markers** on the ground. The meeting also **reaffirmed** previous **consensus** reached at Kazan, **emphasising** a fair and reasonable approach based on the 2005 Agreement on Political Parameters and Guiding Principles for Settlement of the Boundary Question.

Beyond security and **diplomacy**, the dialogue also **touched** on people-to-people and economic **ties** where both nations agreed to resume direct flights at the earliest, ease visa **facilitation**, and expand Indian **pilgrimages** to Mount Kailash and Lake Manasarovar. Border trade is set to resume at three **designated** points-Lipulekh Pass, Shipki La, and Nathu La-while discussions will continue to enhance trade and investment flows. This was **indeed** unthinkable a few months back. The visit comes **against a complex backdrop** of global economic tensions. India recently faced US President Donald Trump's announcement of a 25 per cent **tariff** on Indian goods, with an additional **levy** on oil imports from Russia. Similarly, the US and China remain locked in tariff disputes. Improved India-China relations could help both countries better **navigate** these shifting economic **dynamics**, reducing dependency on Western markets and creating **space** for **bilateral** cooperation. **Ironically** it is Trump who is **facilitating** Indo-China rapprochement. Security cooperation is also likely to be **strengthened**. The two countries have agreed to **establish** General Level **Mechanisms** in the Eastern and Middle Sectors **in addition to** the existing mechanism in the Western Sector. **A working group** under the WMCC **will** focus on effective border management to ensure continued peace and stability. Prime Minister Modi is expected to attend the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO rapprochement) summit in China later this year, signalling India's **willingness** to engage **constructively** on **multilateral** platforms.

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

[Practice Exercise]

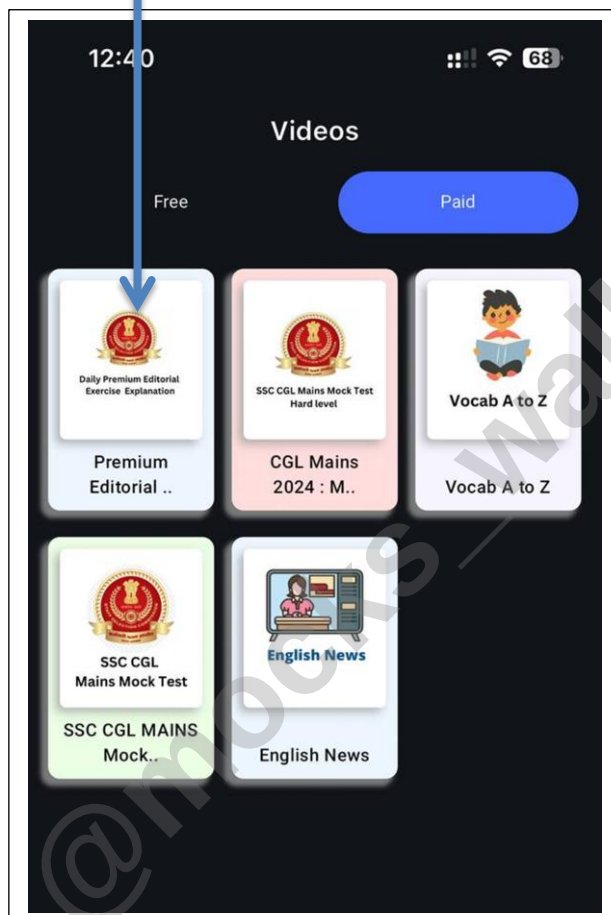
Vocabulary

1. **Rapprochement** (noun) – reconciliation, détente, fence-mending, normalization, rapprochement of ties मेल-मिलाप/ दोस्ती
2. **Concerted** (adjective) – coordinated, joint, unified, collective, combined समन्वित
3. **Resolve** (verb) – settle, address, iron out, work out, reconcile हल करना
4. **Long-standing** (adjective) – enduring, long-running, persistent, timeworn, long-established दीर्घकालिक
5. **Plague** (verb) – afflict, bedevil, trouble, torment, dog परेशान करना
6. **Momentum** (noun) – impetus, traction, drive, headway, steam गति-बल
7. **Respite** (noun) – relief, breather, reprieve, lull, pause राहत
8. **Uneasy** (adjective) – strained, tense, fraught, uncomfortable, edgy असहज
9. **Disrupt** (verb) – interrupt, derail, hamper, upend, cripple बाधित करना
10. **Clash** (noun) – skirmish, confrontation, conflict, face-off, altercation झड़प
11. **Look up** (phrasal verb) – improve, brighten, pick up, turn around, get better सुधरना
12. **Restore** (verb) – reinstate, resume, reestablish, renew, bring back बहाल करना
13. **Cordial** (adjective) – warm, amicable, friendly, genial, affable सौहार्दपूर्ण
14. **Significant** (adjective) – notable, meaningful, important, substantial, consequential महत्वपूर्ण
15. **Breakthrough** (noun) – advance, milestone, game-changer, leap, headway बड़ी सफलता
16. **Thaw** (noun) – make or become friendlier or more cordial. पिघलाव
17. **Decisive** (adjective) – conclusive, definitive, resolute, firm, pivotal निर्णायक
18. **Reset** (verb) – recalibrate, realign, reboot, renew, restart पुनर्संयोजित करना
19. **Strategic** (adjective) – long-term, calculated, tactical, policy-level, geostrategic रणनीतिक
20. **Break the ice** (phrase) – to say or do something that makes people feel more relaxed, especially at the beginning of a party or meeting बातचीत शुरू करना, बात छेड़ना
21. **Result in** (phrasal verb) – lead to, bring about, cause, culminate in, yield परिणाम होना
22. **Settlement** (noun) – resolution, accord, agreement, deal, arrangement समझौता

23. **Set up** (phrasal verb) – establish, constitute, form, create, institute स्थापित करना
24. **Explore** (verb) – examine, consider, probe, study, assess तलाशना
25. **Mutually** (adverb) – jointly, reciprocally, collectively, together, bilaterally पारस्परिक रूप से
26. **Framework** (noun) – structure, blueprint, schema, roadmap, architecture रूपरेखा
27. **Delimit** (verb) – demarcate, define, draw, mark out, set boundaries सीमांकन करना
28. **Erect** (verb) – build, put up, install, raise, construct खड़ा करना
29. **Marker** (noun) – boundary post, landmark, indicator, signpost, beacon सूचक
30. **Reaffirm** (verb) – restate, reassert, confirm, underscore, reiterate पुनर्पुष्टि करना
31. **Consensus** (noun) – agreement, unanimity, common ground, concurrence, accord सर्वसम्मति
32. **Emphasise** (verb) – stress, underscore, highlight, accentuate, foreground जोर देना
33. **Diplomacy** (noun) – statecraft, foreign policy, negotiation, tact, diplomatic engagement कूटनीति
34. **Touch** (verb) – address, cover, broach, mention, allude to उल्लेख करना
35. **Ties** (noun) – relations, links, connections, bonds, relationship संबंध
36. **Facilitation** (noun) – easing, enabling, assistance, streamlining, support सुविधाकरण
37. **Pilgrimage** (noun) – holy journey, yatra, religious trek, spiritual voyage, sacred visit तीर्थयात्रा
38. **Designated** (adjective) – appointed, assigned, earmarked, specified, nominated नामित
39. **Indeed** (adverb) – certainly, truly, really, surely, in fact सचमुच
40. **Against a backdrop of** (phrase) – amid, in the context of, against the background of, amidst, set against की पृष्ठभूमि में
41. **Tariff** (noun) – duty, levy, import tax, customs, impost शुल्क
42. **Levy** (noun) – charge, duty, tax, assessment, imposition कर
43. **Navigate** (verb) – steer, manage, negotiate, chart, traverse सँभालना
44. **Dynamic** (noun) – trend, trajectory, momentum, interplay, shifting equation गतिशीलता

45. **Space** (noun) – room, scope, latitude, leeway, breathing space गुंजाइश
46. **Bilateral** (adjective) – two-sided, reciprocal, mutual, dyadic, intergovernmental द्विपक्षीय
47. **Ironically** (adverb) – paradoxically, oddly, curiously, wryly, unexpectedly विडंबनापूर्वक
48. **Facilitate** (verb) – enable, ease, expedite, aid, foster सुगम करना
49. **Strengthen** (verb) – bolster, reinforce, fortify, deepen, consolidate मज़बूत करना
50. **Establish** (verb) – set up, found, institute, create, constitute स्थापित करना
51. **Mechanism** (noun) – process, system, apparatus, arrangement, setup तंत्र
52. **In addition to** (phrase) – besides, apart from, as well as, along with, over and above के अतिरिक्त
53. **Willingness** (noun) – readiness, openness, eagerness, consent, inclination तत्परता
54. **Constructively** (adverb) – productively, positively, helpfully, in good faith, pragmatically रचनात्मक रूप से
55. **Multilateral** (adjective) – many-sided, plurilateral, multinational, collective, international बहुपक्षीय

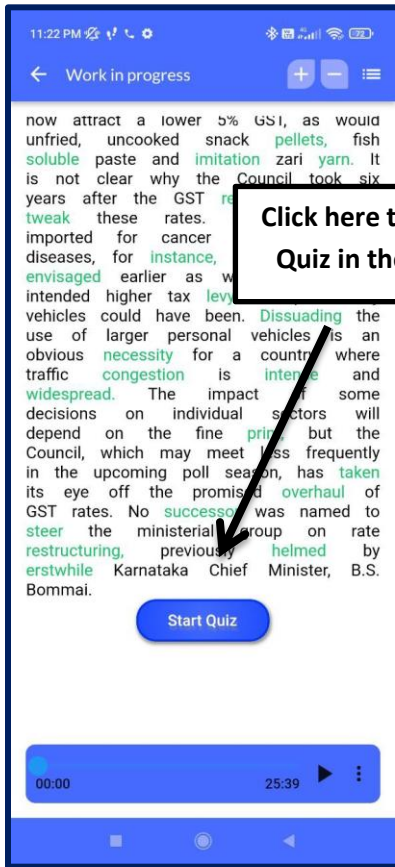
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



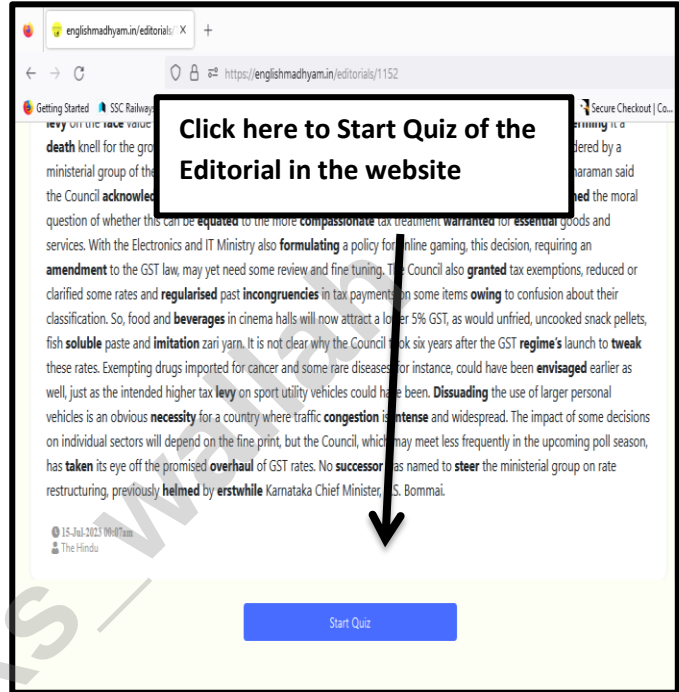
Summary of the Editorial

1. India and China are making renewed efforts to resolve long-standing tensions in bilateral relations.
2. The relationship had deteriorated after incidents like the Galwan clash in 2020 and even visa services were disrupted.
3. Recently, relations have seen improvement with the restoration of visa services and expectations of more confidence-building measures.
4. A major breakthrough came during Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi's visit, where he met Prime Minister Narendra Modi and External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar.
5. The meetings focused on building trust, reducing tensions, and working toward an early boundary settlement.
6. An Expert Group under the WMCC (Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination on India-China Border Affairs) will explore a mutually acceptable framework for delimiting the border.
7. The boundary resolution will be based on legal and political definitions rather than physical demarcation.
8. Both sides reaffirmed earlier consensus, including the 2005 Agreement on Political Parameters and Guiding Principles for boundary settlement.
9. Beyond security, the talks also covered economic and people-to-people ties.
10. Agreements were made to resume direct flights, ease visa facilitation, and expand pilgrimages to Mount Kailash and Lake Manasarovar.
11. Border trade is set to reopen at Lipulekh Pass, Shipki La, and Nathu La.
12. The timing is crucial as global trade tensions intensify, with the U.S. imposing tariffs on India and remaining in disputes with China.
13. Improved India-China ties may help both countries reduce dependency on Western markets and strengthen bilateral cooperation.
14. Security cooperation will expand with General Level Mechanisms being established in the Eastern and Middle Sectors, complementing the Western Sector mechanism.
15. Prime Minister Modi's likely participation in the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) summit in China will further signal India's willingness to engage constructively on multilateral platforms.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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